

Philipp Hilbert. *Principal PM building API-first travel commerce platforms.*

Positioning, ten years turning 0-to-1 bets into revenue-generating platforms, marketplace economics, developer experience, and cross-team orchestration built in.

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§ WHY HOPPER

HTS is already doing something structurally interesting: it turned Hopper's consumer fintech into a B2B distribution layer that now represents more than 75% of the business. The API Marketplace is the next logical layer, making those capabilities discoverable, priceable, and self-serve for enterprise partners rather than locked in bespoke deals with Capital One and Air Canada. That packaging problem, deciding what a "Ranking" or "Deduplication/Auction" capability looks like as a commercial API product, and what the right take-rate model is per capability, is exactly the kind of 0-to-1 I find most interesting to think through. *That is the kind of structural platform problem where the PM role is genuinely creative, not just facilitative.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **Lovable**, rapid partner-portal mockups
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic refactors and scaffolding
- **GitHub Copilot**, inline code assistance
- **GPT**, edge-case and documentation drafting
- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
- **Framer**, design-heavy UX prototypes

- **Gamma.app**, internal pitch decks and partner briefs

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), MongoDB, Kafka, SQL, Dagster, dbt, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Django, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model so neither side reveals identity before commitment; protects both parties through the funnel.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing onboarding friction for field workers.
- LLM agents across the funnel so one operator runs the day-to-day without a support team.
- Directly transferable to the HTS marketplace pattern: take-rate design, supply-side incentives, and partner onboarding as product primitives.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT HOPPER

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow each capability PM, Connect, Search Polygons, Ranking, Extranet, and map what each team's API surface actually exposes today versus what an enterprise partner would expect to buy, flagging packaging gaps and undocumented constraints.

WEEK 2

Mock, price, validate.

Build a working prototype partner portal and mock API catalogue using Lovable and Claude Code, run it past one real prospective partner, and surface the first take-rate and packaging assumptions worth stress-testing with Finance.

WEEK 3+

Ship the developer loop.

Deliver the sandbox environment spec and first API documentation standard, sequence the first commercial launch with Commercial, and close the loop on partner onboarding time-to-first-value as the primary marketplace metric.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hopper team,

The HTS API Marketplace role is a specific kind of problem I have been building toward. Hopper has already done the hard part: the underlying capabilities, pricing, content mapping, ranking, deduplication, exist and are battle-tested at scale. The work now is to package them as coherent, commercially attractive API products that enterprise partners can discover, evaluate, and integrate without a six-month bespoke deal cycle. That is a platform design and commercial model problem as much as a product problem, and it is one I have thought about seriously across several engagements.

At Kvitt Payment Solutions I took a B2B fintech product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, which meant designing a commercial model, a developer integration path, and a partner onboarding experience with essentially no template to follow. At construct8, my construction-staffing marketplace, I designed the take-rate model, the supply-side incentives, and the anonymity-until-payment mechanic that protects both sides, then validated it with real partners using SQL funnel analysis. At EMIL Group I owned a B2B SaaS platform for insurers and reinsurers and learned what enterprise clients actually need from an API product: predictability, clear documentation, and a sandbox they trust before they let it near their production stack.

On the AI-native working style: I reach for Claude Code, Lovable, and Cursor before I write a PRD. At Rohde & Schwarz I used this to instrument two competing product strategies, a UI-led and a developer-code-first approach, and the data made the decision obvious before any engineering resources were committed. The same approach applies here: I would mock the partner portal, simulate pricing configurations, and run a real partner through an onboarding

flow before asking engineering to build anything. The goal is to collapse the distance between a hypothesis and a signal.

The cross-team coordination piece is something I have done at scale. At Rohde & Schwarz I led fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists across multinational teams with no single reporting line. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I coordinated across QA, DevOps, and policy stakeholders to carry a full ETL migration and a UI relaunch in parallel. At Hopper, the marketplace PM role is effectively a capability-synthesis function, synthesising roadmaps from Connect, Search Polygons, Ranking, Extranet, and others into a coherent external product, which is a coordination model I recognise and know how to run.

I am based in Berlin, available fully remote, and can start within four weeks of an offer. I would be glad to walk through how I would approach the commercial model design for one or two of the HTS capabilities in a first conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership, including multiple 0-to-1 launches across B2B SaaS, fintech, insurance, and marketplace products. I design commercial models and developer experiences for platform businesses, coordinate across capability teams without owning their engineering, and use AI-native prototyping to validate assumptions before committing resources. My work spans regulated industries and distributed, cross-functional teams.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Platform and marketplace product management: B2B API product design, take-rate and commercial model design, developer experience, partner onboarding, enterprise packaging, go-to-market sequencing

AI-native product execution: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, Framer, GPT, n8n agentic workflows, LLM-assisted spec and edge-case generation, rapid prototyping before PRD

Analytics and data: SQL, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MicroStrategy, Matomo

Product ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, backlog refinement, sprint planning, roadmap ownership, MVP definition, A/B testing, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, GitOps rollout with ArgoCD, CI/CD, release gating

Technical environments: REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, Jenkins, Azure DevOps

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI)

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment from days to 30 minutes; redirected platform strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first after instrumenting both workflows, lifting pipeline runs by 200%; led 15+ engineers and data scientists across multinational Scrum teams on the FCAS programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to automate quarterly ETL imports, saving ~75% of update time; integrated test automation into Jenkins; migrated bare-metal system to containers; served as Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures, user acceptance rose fivefold; implemented CGM hospital information system interface, reducing anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS, INSURANCE 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams, reducing attrition from near-total to a single departure; shipped the Claims Center 0-to-1; cut new insurance product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND
PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results to production in a full SAFe environment with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT
DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE, B2B
PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; owned backlog, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B STAFFING
MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one solo: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds: owned financial planning and investor reporting for a nanotechnology fertiliser product.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH, P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · HOPPER

